

Sangyeon Cho

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Research Interests

My research interests lie in **causal inference** and **uncertainty quantification** for reliable **decision-making**. I am particularly interested in clarifying the assumptions under which causal conclusions are justified, characterizing uncertainty in causal estimates and predictions, and determining when the available evidence supports action, deferral, or further information. Ultimately, I aim to help bridge the gap between theory and real-world applications in domains such as epidemiology, finance, and public policy.

Education

Seoul National University, Seoul, Republic of Korea

Doctor of Philosophy in Data Science

Sep 2026–Present

Advisor: Sanghack Lee

Master of Data Science

Aug 2026

Advisor: Sanghack Lee

Thesis: *Conformal Prediction for Individual Treatment Effects under Time-Varying Treatment Strategies*

B.A. in Economics

Aug 2024

Research Experience

Graduate Student Researcher

Sep 2024–Present

Causality Lab, Seoul National University

- *Causal Inference–Based Policy Optimization for Determining Unsecured Personal Loan Terms (AFINIT)* 2026–Present

Project Team Lead

- *AI Platform for Predicting Drug Efficacy and Side Effects from Integrated Medical and Multi-omics Data* (Ministry of Food and Drug Safety) 2026–Present
- *Advancing Credit Decision Making (AFINIT)* 2025–2026

Project Team Lead: Coordinated research across members while contributing directly to methodology and experiments; the work resulted in the *OPERA-S* manuscript and a Korean patent application and corresponding PCT application (co-inventor).

- *Metabolomic Big Data Analysis* (Ministry of Food and Drug Safety) 2025

Analyzed Korean cohort multi-omics data through the lenses of causal inference, uncertainty quantification, and explainability, leading to a co-first-authored manuscript on decomposing conformal uncertainty.

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Jul 2023–Aug 2024

Causality Lab, Seoul National University

- Developed a research idea titled *Causal Structure and Effect Analysis of South Korea's Low Birth Rate Policy Based on Structural Causal Models*. **Excellence Award, Research Idea Track (2024 CSES Competition)**

Manuscripts

* for equal contribution, † for corresponding authors.

Sangyeon Cho^{*}, Minyoung Cho^{*}, Jungsoo Kim^{*}, Sujeong Oh, and Sanghack Lee[†]. Decomposing Conformal Uncertainty: Calibration- and Instance-Driven Feature Attribution. *Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2026. *Accepted*.

Sangyeon Cho^{*}, Minyoung Cho^{*}, Jungsoo Kim^{*}, and Sanghack Lee[†]. A Tale of Two Uncertainties: Global–Local Attribution for Conformal Prediction. *2nd Workshop on Epistemic Intelligence in Machine Learning (EIML)*, ICML 2026 (non-archival). **Spotlight Talk**

Hyunwoo Kim, Gyeongchan Han, Bogeun Kim, Serjin Kim, **Sangyeon Cho**, Junha Ham, Jaehyeok Shin, and Sanghack Lee[†]. *OPERA-S: Deterministic Tail Safety in Ensemble Off-Policy Evaluation*. *under review*.

Jaeho Jeong, **Sangyeon Cho**, Ji Won Bae, and Sanghack Lee[†]. Conformal Meta-learner for Individual Treatment Effects under Unmeasured Confounding. *work in progress*.

Academic Service

Reviewer, Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)

2026

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Seoul National University

- *Machine Learning and Deep Learning for Data Science II* (Fall 2026)
- *Causal Inference for Data Science* (Spring 2026)
- *Computing Foundations for Data Science* (Spring 2025, Fall 2025; taught two class sessions)

Skills

Languages

- Korean: Native
- English: TOEFL iBT 5.5/6 (110/120 on the previous scale)

Technical Skills

- Programming Languages: Python, C, C++
- Libraries and Frameworks: PyTorch, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas, Polars

Additional Information

Relevant Coursework

Linear Algebra; Econometrics; Mathematical Foundations of Deep Neural Networks; Computing for Data Science; Machine Learning and Deep Learning for Data Science I–II; Big Data and Knowledge Management System I–II; Data Science Bootcamp, SNU — completed with honors: Linear algebra, vector calculus, probability and statistical inference; Python, data structures, C programming, and computer systems.

Military Service

KATUSA (Korean Augmentation to the United States Army), 2020–2021